

The Research Desk

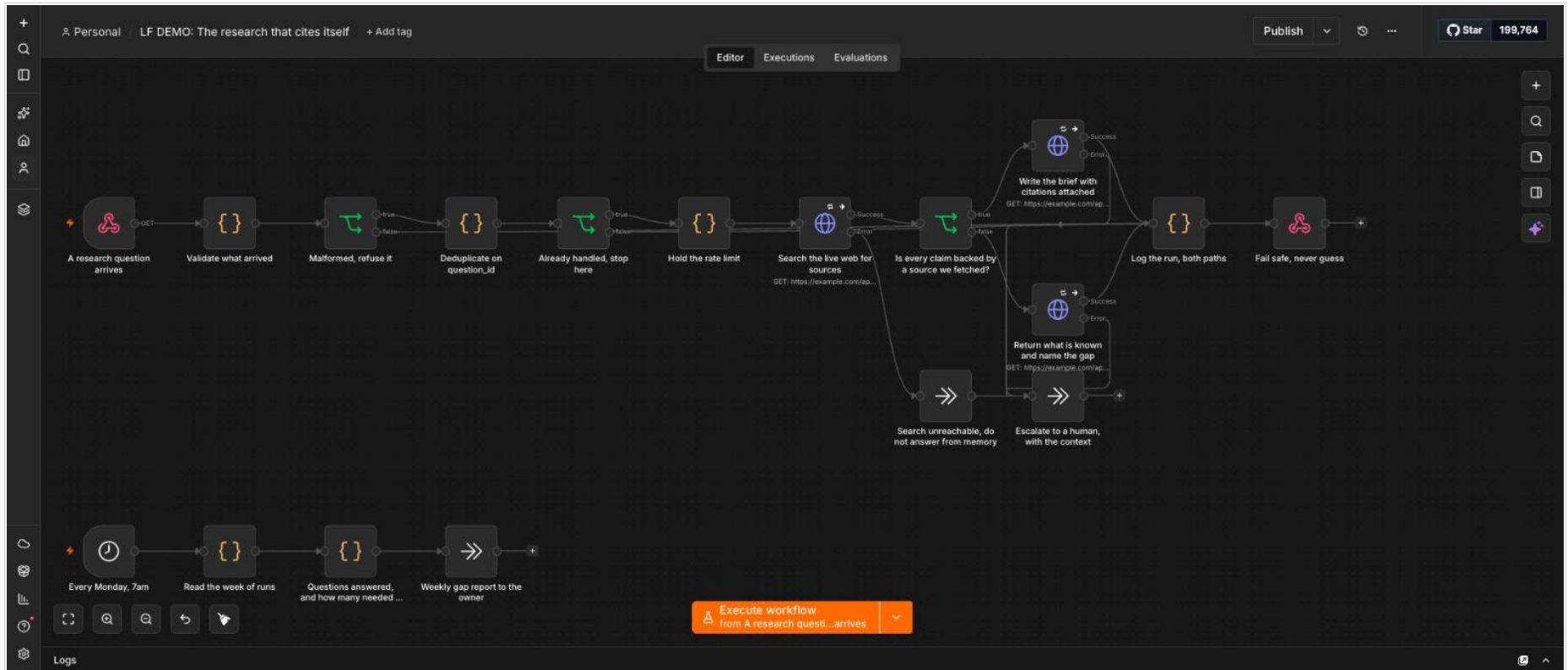
ai-research-agent · built in n8n

An agent that researches is easy. An agent that can show you where every sentence came from is the one you can actually put in front of a client.

What it connects to: The model is a renter, not an owner. The sources live on the web, the output has to land in something a person opens, and the agent is only the middle.

1 of 3 SYSTEM

Here's the research pass — question in, live sources fetched, brief out, and the sources kept.



2 of 3 THINKING

This is the gate that makes it usable: if a claim is not backed by something it actually fetched, it does not go in the brief. It says what it does not know instead.

The screenshot displays a workflow editor interface with a dark theme. The main workspace is divided into three vertical panels: INPUT, CONFIGURATION, and OUTPUT.

- INPUT Panel:** Contains a message "No input data" and a button "Execute previous nodes" with the text "to view input data" below it.
- CONFIGURATION Panel:** Has tabs for "Parameters" and "Settings".
 - Conditions:** A section with a text input field containing a JSON expression: `{{ $json.allClaimsCited == true && $json.sources.length >= 3 }}`. To the right of the input is a dropdown menu currently set to "is true". Below the input is a "+ Add condition" button.
 - Options:** A section with a toggle switch labeled "Convert types where required" (currently off) and a "+ Add option" button.
- OUTPUT Panel:** Labeled "OUTPUT" on the right side.

At the top of the CONFIGURATION panel, there is an orange button labeled "Execute step".

3 of 3 RESULT

And the weekly scorecard: how many answers needed a human, and how thin the sourcing was when they did. Depth measured in sources actually read, not in output length.

{} Questions answered, and how many needed a human

INPUT

→

No input data

Execute previous nodes

to view input data

ParametersSettings

Mode

Run Once for All Items

Language

JavaScript

JavaScript

CodeAsk AI

```
1 // Questions answered, and how many needed a human – the honest
  scorecard.
2 const asked = Object.values($getWorkflowStaticData('global').research
  || {});
3 const week = asked.filter(q => q.at > Date.now() - 7*864e5);
4 const uncited = week.filter(q => !q.allClaimsCited);
5 const thin = week.filter(q => (q.sources || 0) < 3);
6 const avgSources = week.length
7   ? Math.round(week.reduce((n, q) => n + (q.sources || 0), 0) /
  week.length * 10) / 10
8   : 0;
9 return [{ json: {
10   asked: week.length,
11   handedToAHuman: uncited.length,
12   avgSources,
13   note: thin.length
14   ? `${thin.length} answers rested on fewer than three sources. That
```

Type \$ for a list of **special vars/methods**. Debug by using console.log() statements and viewing their output in the browser console.